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ENDING 2025 STRONGER AS DOSTONESCIGLAT FAMILY: DOST ILOCOS REGION’S YEAR-END PROGRAM WITH A PURPOSE

The Department of Science and Technology Ilocos Region (DOST Ilocos Region) meaningfully closed the year 2025 through its Year-End Program held on December 18–19, 2025, at EM Royale Hotel and Beach Resort in Taboc, San Juan, La Union. The two-day activity brought together employees not only to celebrate the year’s accomplishments but also to reflect, give back, and prepare for the year ahead. Through the guidance and leadership of Regional Director Teresita

A. Tabaog, the Year-End Program emphasized unity, appreciation, and shared purpose. Director Tabaog encouraged everyone to take time to reflect on both individual and collective efforts that contributed to the successful implementation of DOST programs and services across the region. One of the key activities was the 2025 Individual Performance Accomplishment Review for Contract of Service (COS) employees. This activity provided a platform for

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DOST boosts capacity to turn research and data into bankable projects and national policies

By Joy Calvar, DOST Gates Program



The Department of Science and Technology (DOST) is taking significant strides toward

strengthening its capacity to transform technical data and research insights into bankable project pro-

posals and evidence-informed policies that drive national development. The initiative was

led by the Office of the Assistant Secretary for Development Coopera-

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CITRONELLA CONVENTION CULMINATES WITH A CALL FOR COLLABORATION AND ACTION



LAL-LO, CAGAYAN — The 1st Regional Citronella Convention held in Lal-lo, Cagayan concluded on a hopeful and inspiring note, bringing together local leaders, scientists, and community members

united by one goal — to strengthen the citronella industry in the region. In her heartfelt message, Hon. Maria Olive B. Pascual, Lal-lo Vice Mayor and President of the Rural Improvement

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CITRONELLA CONVENTION
CULMINATES WITH A CALL...
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Club (RIC), praised the efforts of women and farmers behind the thriving citronella movement. “Gusto ko lang sabihing hindi mahirap mangarap pero kailangan meron kang gawin para ito ay makamit mo — at iyan po ang ginagawa ng Rural Improvement Club (RIC) members natin — ang backbone ng citronella industry dito sa Lal-lo,” she said, recognizing the RIC’s hands-on dedication to community development. Engr. Maria Teresa B. De Guzman, DOST Assistant Secretary for Countryside Development, urged participants to turn lessons into tangible actions. “Let us prove that through science and collaboration, we can build a greener, healthier, and more prosperous countryside for all,” she emphasized. “Plant those

citronella saplings, refine that oil, develop that product, draft those supportive policies, and continue this network of collaboration beyond this convention hall.” Capping the event, Dr. Virginia G. Bilgera, DOST Region 02 Regional Director, highlighted the importance of partnerships in sustaining initiatives like this. “DOST cannot do this alone, we need partners and that is why we are here together. This is not just the end, this is just a beginning. Congratulations to everyone who became part of this regional event!” As the curtains closed, the convention left participants inspired — a testament that through science, unity, and community spirit, Lal-lo’s citronella industry is set to bloom stronger than ever.

ENDING 2025 STRONGER
AS DOSTONE SCIGLAT
FAMILY... FROM PAGE 1



employees to reflect on their accomplishments, strengthen accountability to their assigned tasks, and share innovative ideas, actions, and initiatives implemented throughout the year. The spirit of the holidays was also shared with the community through a Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) Gift-Giving Activity held at San Fernando South Central Integrated School. The activity brought joy and meaningful support to learners under the Learners with Special Educational Needs (LSEN) Program, highlighting the DOST Ilocos Region’s commitment to inclusive and people-centered service. Adding excitement to the celebration was the Search for Mr. and Ms. SCIGLAT 2025, where six candidates confidently represented their respective teams. The event showcased confidence, creativity, and teamwork, with strong support from colleagues. Dr. Ismael D. Gurtiza, former Assistant Regional Director for Field Operations and current member of the Regional Technical Evaluation Committee (RTEC), served as one of the board of judges together with Director Tabaog and Ms. Carla Joyce B. Cajala, SRS II of DOST Ilocos Region. Team spirit continued with indoor and outdoor

team-building activities, where participants took part in physical and mental challenges designed to promote collaboration, trust, and camaraderie. The friendly competitions fostered stronger connections among team members and reinforced the value of working together toward common goals. Beyond celebration and reflection, the Year-End Program also focused on future planning. A review meeting was conducted under the leadership of Director Tabaog in preparation for the 2026 Regional Science, Technology, and Innovation Week (RSTW). The meeting served as an important first step to ensure smooth planning, effective coordination, and informed decision-making, drawing insights from the successful conduct of the 2025 National Science, Technology, and Innovation Week (NSTW). As DOST Ilocos Region closes 2025, the Year-End Program stands as a strong reminder that its greatest strength lies in its people. United as DOSTOneSCIGLAT family, the region moves into 2026 with renewed purpose, strengthened partnerships, and a clear focus on bringing science, technology, and innovation closer to communities, creating meaningful impact and lasting change for the region I. oOo

NEW YEAR INCIDENTS,
BUMABA SA CAVITE



Ayon sa datos ng Cavite Police Provincial Office (PPO), bumaba sa province of Cavite ang mga kaso ng holiday-related incidents noong New Year celebrations. Acting Provincial Director Col. Ariel Red reported a sharp drop in firecracker- and pyrotechnics-related injuries. Data from the Ligtas Paskuhan campaign showed a 75-percent decrease in incidents, from 36 cases in 2024 to just eight in 2025. All recorded cases involved firecracker- and pyrotechnics-related injuries. The Cavite PPO reported no incidents of indiscriminate firing, stray bullets, road crashes, or fires linked to fireworks and pyrotechnic devices. Col. Red attributed the peaceful celebration to the combined efforts of law enforce-

ers, local government units, and the public. “The remarkable decrease in incidents during the New Year’s celebration is proof of the effective implementation of the laws and the cooperation of the people,” he said, adding that public discipline played a crucial role in ensuring safety across the province. The Cavite PPO also cited intensified operations against illegal firecrackers and loose firearms, heightened police visibility, and close coordination with local government units and the Caviteño community as key factors behind the positive outcome. The provincial police force extended its gratitude to partner agencies, LGUs, and residents for their continued support in maintaining peace and order.

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DOST boosts capacity to turn research and data... From page 1



tion and the Geospatial Analytics and Technology Solutions (GATES) Program, in collaboration with the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) Philippines, experts from the University of the Philippines - National College of Public Administration and Governance (UP NCPAG), and the National Research Council of the Philippines (NRCP). A Vision for Data-Driven Governance In his speech, DOST Secretary Renato U. Solidum, Jr. emphasized that the department's goal is to evolve into an agile, data-driven, and future-ready organization that transforms information into national value. He underscored that decisions must be firmly grounded in evidence to ensure they align with global cooperation priorities and national development goals. "Data must be connected. It must speak a common language. It must move from information to insight to action," Secretary Solidum stated. "As the Department that leads innovation, we must also lead

in harmonization, integration, and translation". Strengthening Proposal Development for Global Competitiveness In collaboration with the UNDP Philippines, the first two days of the series focused on developing high-impact project proposals. Experts guided participants through problem framing and stakeholder mapping to create a pipeline of project concept notes addressing three strategic areas: human capital development, innovation and economic development, and climate change and disaster risk reduction. UNDP Resident Representative Knut Ostby noted that improving the ability to leverage Official Development Assistance (ODA) and external financing positions science and technology initiatives as catalysts for private-sector engagement and domestic investment. "This is about scaling innovations where they are needed most," Otsby said. DOST Assistant Secretary for Development Mr. Rodolfo J. Calzado, Jr. also encouraged

participants to further develop their group outputs into full draft concept notes, as these will serve as a preparatory step for the proposed one-on-one coaching sessions with the UNDP team scheduled to begin in the early months of 2026, refining the outputs into investment-ready project concept notes. Bridging Research to Policy and Open Data The final day of the series, conducted with experts from the UP-NCPAG, focused on the research-to-policy landscape. Participants explored pathways to translate technical findings into actionable insights for national and sectoral policies while discussing the institutionalization of open data to advance good governance and transparency. Asec. Calzado, Jr. concluded that while the DOST system generates a wealth of geospatial data and technical knowledge annually, impact only occurs when that data is translated into strategic, people-centered action. By maximizing the use of its organizational data through

the GATES Program, DOST continues to reinforce its commitment to a data-driven government that provides solutions and opportunities for all Filipinos. Through the "Collaborate, Translate, Transform: Seminar and Writeshop Series on Partnership and Proposal Development, Research Translation, and Policy Development," held from December 2 to 4, 2025, the Department gathered representatives from its Central Office and attached agencies to bridge the gap between information generation and actionable results. GATES Program is one of the eight banner research and development programs of the Department of Science and Technology (DOST) aimed at providing science-based, innovative, and inclusive solutions across four strategic pillars: human well-being, wealth creation, wealth protection, and sustainability. These pillars embody the mantra One-DOST4U: Solutions and Opportunities for All. For more information, visit www.dost.gov.ph. oOo

SHOWBLITZ

By: Charlene Mae

Relasyon nina Juliana at Ricci may hard launch, sasabihin ni Lucy hinihintay!



Ahh, sina Juliana Gomez at Ricci Rivero na talaga. Ito ang reaction ng mga internet user matapos kumalat ang video nilang HHWW (holding hands while walking) sa mall. Actually, parang hindi naman conscious sina Juliana and Ricci kung makita silang holding hands sa nasabing video. Obviously, ang basketbolista ang sina-bi ni Cong. Richard na umaaligid sa anak niya last November pa 'yun, sa huli naming interview sa actor/politician sa promo ng comeback movieniyang Salvageland. After Andrea Brillantes na controversial ang naging breakup, nakarelasyon ni Ricci ang beauty queen-turned-politician Leren Bautista. Anyway, naka-excite marinig ang magiging comment ni Mayor Lucy if ever na hingan siya ng komento tungkol sa basketbolistang sinasabing karelasyon ng unica hija nila ni Cong. Goma. May pagka-komedyana si Ormoc Mayor Lucy Torres ng bronze medal sa women's team epee event. oOo



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SPORTS NEWS

Eala tinalo si Linette papasok sa Semis

MANILA, Philippines — Walang balak si Alex Eala na tumigil matapos muling umarangkada para pataubin si fifth seed Magda Linette ng Poland, 6–3, 6–2, upang magmartsa sa semifinals ng ASB Classic kahapon sa ASB Tennis Centre sa Auckland, New Zealand.

Palung-palo si Eala nang ilabas nito ang kaniyang bangus upang hindi na papormahin pa si Linette at masiguro ang kaniyang unang semis stint sa season na ito. Dikdikan ang laban sa pagsisimula ng laro kung saan nauwi ang iskor sa 2-2 pagtatapla.

Subalit uma-rangkada si Eala nang pakawalan nito ang malulupit na hits para maitarak ang 4-1 run at makuha ang 1-0 kalamangan. Lalo pang nag-init

ang 20-anyos Pinay netter sa second set nang mailista nito ang umaatikabong 4-0 run matapos makuha ang dalawang break points.

Sinubukang pumalag ni Linette nang kumana ito ng dalawang sunod na games para makadikit sa 2-4.

Pero agad na nagising si Eala na nagpakawala ng solidong end game para tuluyang patalsikin si Linette.

Masaya si Eala sa kaniyang naging performance ngunit aminado itong hindi rin ito naging madali para sa kaniya lalo pa’t malalim ang karanasan ng 30-anyos na si Linette. “Obviously Magda, being such an experienced player, I’ve had difficulties playing against her before. So I’m happy that I’m seeing my level increase and improve,” ani Eala.

Makakasagupa

ni Eala sa semifinals si Xinyu Wang ng China na nanaig kay Franchesca Jones ng Great Britain, 6-4, 4-3 (ret.).

Nauna nang tinalo ni Eala sina Croatian netters Donna Vekic sa opening round at Petra Marcinko sa second round.

Sa pagpasok sa semis, makasisiguro na si Eala ng tumataginting na \$12,331 papremyo o mahigit P700,000.

Bukod pa rito ang pagkakataong umangat sa WTA rankings.

Sa kasalukuyang nasa No. 48 na si Eala sa WTA live rankings para maitala ang kaniyang bagong career-high ranking.

Nakamit ng reigning Southeast Asian Games champion na si Eala ang pinakamataas na ranking na No. 50.

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